



Marcin Nowicki

Staff Software Engineer — CI/CD & Developer Tooling

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Engineer with 30+ years in technology — all remote — building CI/CD infrastructure and developer tooling at scale. Coordinated with 200+ engineers across organizations at Toptal, built company-wide CI systems at Oyster, and led teams from inception through self-sufficiency. Passionate about tools that multiply engineering quality and velocity.

EXPERIENCE

Operational Staff Engineer → Lead Engineer

2022.04 – Present

Oyster HR — Entire Engineering / Total Rewards Team

- Built company-wide CI system from scratch, migrating from GitHub Actions to a unified pipeline serving all engineering teams.
- Building agentic AI developer tooling ecosystem (open-source) — autonomous NixOS agent nodes that open PRs, run specs, and maintain 30+ repositories independently; declarative agent configuration; cross-agent persistent memory.
- Shaped engineering behavior through high-level BDD frameworks — used RSpec tooling to resolve cross-team communication issues with the Data Team.
- Created Sentry notification and triage system adopted as seed pattern across Engineering.
- Scaled impact from single team to entire engineering org — established processes enabling promotions, provided pair programming support and ad-hoc issue resolution company-wide.

Senior Back-End Engineer

2020.10 – 2022.02

Toptal — Goldsmiths Team

- Built GraphQL generators for types and mutations used by 5+ teams across 12 schemas stitched via Apollo Server — eliminated boilerplate across dozens of teams.
- Created custom RuboCop cops preventing anti-patterns in implementation and specs company-wide.
- Drove GraphQL standardization across the company through RFC processes.

Technical Team Lead / Manager

2019.08 – 2020.10

Toptal — Billing Extraction Team

- Scaled team from 4 to 16 engineers; conducted dozens of technical and cultural interviews. Reported to VP of Engineering on a CEO-priority SOA migration project.
- Co-built semi-automated “extraction tool” to decouple monolith engine into separate repositories and services.
- Split team into Back-End and Front-End; found and trained two successor Team Leads. Managed OKRs/KPIs and engineer career paths.

Technical Team Lead / Manager → Senior Back-End Engineer

2016.03 – 2019.06

Toptal — Verticalization Team

- Coordinated with 200+ engineers to implement multi-tenancy support across the entire platform.
- Created “Vertical Wizard” — codified all multi-tenancy knowledge into a database-driven tool, making the team intentionally redundant (“meta-team” philosophy).
- Led company-wide spec performance refactor saving six-figure annual infrastructure costs.
- Implemented company-wide abilities system around verticals. Found and trained successor Team Lead.

Senior Back-End Engineer

2014.10 – 2017.01

Distribution Technologies

- Owned API integrations on transportation platform. Built cross-team developer tooling and championed remote work adoption.

Ruby on Rails Developer

2013.08 – 2014.04

JustGo Music — Social Management Platform

- Integrated multiple external APIs (Facebook, Twitter, Instagram, YouTube, SoundCloud, MixCloud). Metrics via KISS Metrics and Intercom. Hosted on Heroku.

Staff Software Engineer

2011.01 – 2013.08

Mamymo — E-commerce Platform

- All four Staff Engineer aspects: Tech Lead, Architect, Solver, Right Hand. Reported to CEO with a 12-person team.
- Multi-country e-commerce (15 countries, 30 languages, 2–5 brands each) with millions of weekly visits and near-zero downtime tolerance.
- Integrated multiple shopping APIs with SEM-driven landing pages for Google traffic arbitrage.

Technical Team Lead → Developer

2008.08 – 2010.03

Studitemps GmbH (Jobmensa.de)

- Led team of 8 as SCRUM Master. Student job outsourcing platform with geolocation.

Ruby on Rails Developer

2010.03 – 2010.12

Experteer

- Google-friendly job catalog with cross-site API scraping and MongoDB log statistics aggregation.

Founder / Developer

2006.04 – 2008.04

go28days.com — Startup

- Co-founded fertility tracking platform. Custom TeX-based Ruby DSL for charting. Full-stack on Rails 1.x.

Freelance PHP Developer / Linux & Network Administrator

1995 – 2006

- PHP/MySQL projects for local businesses (2000–2006). Managed 2–5 Gentoo Linux servers, 150+ Windows machines and WAN at Wyższa Szkoła Zarządzania w Częstochowie (1995–2000).

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	Ruby, Shell (bash/zsh), JavaScript/TypeScript, Nix, Python, PHP
Frameworks	Ruby on Rails, RSpec, GraphQL, React.js, Stimulus, Backbone.js
CI/CD & Testing	Jenkins, GitHub Actions, HarnessCI, RSpec, Minitest, Capybara, Cucumber, Selenium, RuboCop (custom cops)
Infrastructure	Docker, NixOS, GCP, Terraform, Chef, Ansible, Gentoo/Debian/Alpine Linux
Data & Search	PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, ElasticSearch (Chewy), Redis, Memcached
Architecture	Microservices, SOA, REST, GraphQL (Apollo Federation), Monolith decomposition
AI & Tooling	Agentic AI infrastructure, Autonomous Agents, Claude Code, SDD (CAVEKIT), LLM token optimization (RTK), Vector stores, BM25, Embeddings
Leadership	Scaled Scrum, Kanban, LEAN, OKRs/KPIs, Team building (4→16), Technical mentoring

EDUCATION

Electronic Technician, Computer Systems — Techniczne Zakłady Naukowe, Częstochowa

1997 – 2002

KEY HIGHLIGHTS

- 30+ years in technology, exclusively remote
 - Coordinated with 200+ engineers at Toptal
 - Trained 3+ successor technical leads
 - 260+ OSS repos; 30+ composable Nix CI packages
- Built CI systems for entire engineering organizations
 - Scaled teams from scratch (4→16 engineers)
 - Six-figure annual savings from spec optimization
 - Building agentic AI developer tooling ecosystem